THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

OFFICIAL COURSE WORKBOOK

SELF-IMAGE MASTERY

8 Ways to Strengthen Your Identity & Confidence

You cannot outperform your self-image. Build it deliberately.

SELF-IMAGE & IDENTITY

COURSE WORKBOOK

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INTRODUCTION

Dr. Maxwell Maltz, plastic surgeon and author of Psycho-Cybernetics, made a startling discovery: after performing surgeries that objectively improved appearance, many patients still felt ugly. Their external reality had changed — but their internal self-image had not.

His conclusion transformed psychology: you live and act consistently with your self-image. You cannot consistently outperform it. The solution is not to change your behaviour — it is to change your self-image, and behaviour will follow.

Amy Cuddy's research (featured in this course) demonstrates that self-image is not only psychological — it is physiological. Your body posture changes your hormone levels, which changes your confidence, which changes your performance.

THE 8 WAYS — FRAMEWORK OVERVIEW

1. Audit Your Internal Narrative
The voice in your head is not truth — it is a story. Learn to evaluate it, not automatically believe it.

2. Build the Competence-Confidence Loop
Real confidence comes from demonstrated competence. Start small. Win consistently. Confidence follows.

3. Master Positive Self-Talk Architecture
Replace criticism with coaching. Speak to yourself the way you would speak to someone you deeply believe in.

4. Clarify and Anchor Your Values Identity
"I am the kind of person who..." is the most powerful sentence in identity formation.

5. Set and Hold Healthy Boundaries
Boundaries are not walls — they are expressions of self-respect. They teach others how to treat you.

6. Build Self-Discipline as Identity
Discipline is not punishment. It is the highest form of self-love — doing for yourself what serves your future self.

7. Develop Self-Compassion
Kristin Neff's research shows self-compassion — not self-criticism — produces higher achievement and resilience.

8. Design a Personal Development Trajectory
You are not a finished product. You are a work in progress with a deliberate architect: yourself.

AMY CUDDY'S BODY-MIND CONNECTION — PRESENCE BEFORE PERFORMANCE

Amy Cuddy's viral TED Talk (68M+ views, featured in this course) revealed that body language changes not only how others see us — it changes how we see ourselves.

Two minutes of "power posing" (expansive, open posture) before a high-stakes situation:
- Increases testosterone (confidence) by 20%
- Decreases cortisol (stress) by 25%
- Results in measurably more confident interview performance

The Becoming Institute Application: Your self-image is stored in your body as much as your mind. Change your physiology and you change your psychology.

- Before any high-stakes moment, take 2 minutes in a private space to power pose.
- Stand tall in all contexts — your brain reads your posture as a confidence signal.
- Smile deliberately. The facial feedback hypothesis shows it changes internal emotional state.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

In what situations do you most collapse your posture or shrink your presence? What will you change?

Practise a 2-minute power pose before your next high-stakes conversation. What did you notice?

BRENÉ BROWN'S RESEARCH — VULNERABILITY AND TRUE SELF-IMAGE

Brené Brown (University of Houston) spent 13 years studying vulnerability, shame, and belonging. Her finding: people with a strong, healthy self-image are not those who have eliminated vulnerability — they are those who have made peace with it.

She calls them "Wholehearted" people. They share 10 practices:
1. Authenticity over impression management
2. Self-compassion over self-criticism
3. Gratitude and joy as practices, not feelings
4. Intuition and faith over certainty
5. Creativity and play as essential
6. Rest and stillness as productive
7. Meaningful work — feeling seen and valued
8. Laughter, song, and dance (not taking yourself too seriously)
9. Calm and stillness — not anxiety management
10. Meaningful work that involves contribution

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Which of the 10 Wholehearted practices is most absent in your life right now?

What one practice will you begin this week and how?

COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING — REWIRING THE SELF-CRITICAL NARRATIVE

Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT) established that distorted thinking patterns create distorted self-image. The most common distortions:

1. All-or-Nothing Thinking: "I made one mistake — I am a failure."
2. Overgeneralisation: "This always happens to me."
3. Mental Filter: Filtering out positives and dwelling exclusively on negatives.
4. Disqualifying the Positive: "That compliment doesn't count."
5. Mind Reading: "They think I'm incompetent" (without evidence).
6. Catastrophising: "This will ruin everything."
7. Should Statements: "I should be further along by now."
8. Labelling: "I am lazy" vs "I didn't complete that task today."

The Restructuring Method: Observe the thought. Challenge it with evidence. Replace with a balanced, accurate alternative.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Write one recurring self-critical thought. Challenge it with evidence. Write the accurate alternative:

What label have you given yourself that is limiting your self-image? What is the truth?

IDENTITY-BASED CONFIDENCE — BECOMING WHO YOU DECIDE TO BE

The most durable form of self-image is built on identity declarations — deliberate choices about who you are.

The Becoming Institute Identity Architecture:
Step 1: Define who you are committed to becoming (not who you currently are).
Step 2: Write 5-7 "I am..." statements that reflect that identity.
Step 3: Make daily decisions that give evidence to those statements.
Step 4: When you fail to live up to the identity, do not spiral — simply recommit.
Step 5: Review and update your identity declarations annually.

Example Identity Declarations:
- "I am someone who keeps commitments to myself."
- "I am someone who invests in my growth daily."
- "I am someone who treats challenges as opportunities."
- "I am someone who is becoming a world-class communicator."

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Write your 5-7 Identity Declarations below:

Which declaration will be hardest to live up to? What will you do to begin embodying it this week?

30-DAY TRANSFORMATION PRACTICE PLAN

Week 1 — Awareness & Audit

- Day 1-3: Track every self-critical thought. Do not judge them — just record them.
- Day 4-5: Challenge each recorded thought using the CBT restructuring method.
- Day 6-7: Write your initial 5-7 Identity Declarations.

Week 2 — Body & Presence

- Day 8-10: Practise 2-minute power poses before every high-stakes moment.
- Day 11-12: Audit your posture in 5 contexts. Consciously expand.
- Day 13-14: Practice one Wholehearted habit from Brené Brown's list.

Week 3 — Character Building

- Day 15-17: Set one clear boundary and honour it without apology.
- Day 18-19: Build one daily self-discipline habit that serves your future self.
- Day 20-21: Write a letter from your future (5-year) self to your present self.

Week 4 — Integration & Solidification

- Day 22-25: Live fully from your Identity Declarations. Note evidence daily.
- Day 26-28: Share your Identity Declarations with your accountability partner.
- Day 29-30: Write your Self-Image Manifesto — the permanent record of who you are becoming.

MY TRANSFORMATION COMMITMENT

My single most important goal from this course:

Three specific actions I will take in the next 7 days:

How I will measure my progress:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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This workbook accompanies the "8 Ways to Strengthen Self-Image" course on the Origin platform.

This workbook is your practical companion for transformational learning. Every framework, worksheet, and reflection exercise has been designed to move you from insight to action — from knowing to becoming.

The Becoming Institute believes that education is not a destination — it is a daily practice. Carry this workbook with you. Return to it. Complete the exercises. Discuss them with your accountability partner. Teach them to someone else.

This is not just a guide. This is your blueprint.

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